

Companies only care about two groups of people: their customers and their shareholders. If you're not a customer boycotting the brand, you can be a potential shareholder who actively chooses to avoid or even sell their shares in protest. Companies do whatever they can to keep their shareholders happy; it is in their best interest, after all.

When large numbers of consumers start telling a company that they refuse to engage with them, or hold their shares, they start to listen. After all, it hurts their bottom line when there is less demand and their stock price drops — in the world of business, that is all that matters. Being an activist with your money has the benefit of hitting companies where it hurts the most. Unfortunately, companies are going to take more notice if you pull your shares out than if you stand in front of their office protesting.

I am all for marching and protesting for our rights and fighting for change, but I truly believe investing can be an important part of the overall conversation. Whether it's right or not, we live in a capitalist world, and money talks.

Investors in training know that ethical investing is an important part of their overall journey. It doesn't mean you need to run and invest in as many green-energy funds as you can, but rather that you get to choose investments that align with your morals and views.

No-one gets to have a say on what is right or wrong for your portfolio, except yourself. It's liberating to be able to choose what is important to you and to put your money into the changes you want to see in the world. Making money and making change in the world don't have to be mutually exclusive.